

Bag your lunch. Shop in bulk. Spend four hours clipping coupons. C'mon buddy, slash those expenses—some day you're going to be rich! Hilarious!

These tiresome strategies are a classic response to being stuck in the Slowlane. *Lifestyle degradation*. When you're married to a bad wealth equation, this is resistance. This is like getting a divorce by sleeping on the couch. Since wealth is tied to time and can't be controlled, you're left with kitchen scraps . . . lifestyle degradation in the form of expense reduction. Yup, become a cheapskate.

Wrong. Hoodwinking expenses does not create wealth. *Exploding income and controlling expenses creates wealth*. For example, when I routinely earned \$100,000 per month, I accumulated wealth fast because I maintained control over my expenses. As my income exponentiated, expenses grew linearly and weren't neglected. If my income increased by 100%, expenses only grew by 10%. I didn't accumulate wealth because of expense dickery. *Income explosion and expense control created wealth*.

So what happens when a Slowlaner commits to the expense variable? *Life becomes about what you can't do*. You can't take that trip. You can't buy your kids a decent pair of shoes. You can't own a dream car. You can't subscribe to the movie channels. Yes, the good old "sacrifice your today for the promise of tomorrow." *You settle*.

SLOWLANE VICTORY: FAME OR A GERIATRIC WARD

Why invest in a plan that consumes 40 years of your life and fails most of the time? I wouldn't. The dreary reality is that Slowlane failure doesn't happen overnight; failure transpires over the years like a termite-infested woodshed, and when its denizens come to judgment, it's too late. Yes, Slowlane victory is as tough as a truck-stop sirloin.

In a 2002 AARP (formerly the American Association of Retired Persons) survey, 69% of the respondents said they would need to work past retirement age. A year earlier, 45% said they would need to work into their 70s and 80s. We can deduce something disturbing from this data: *The Slowlane's failure rate is near 70%*.

Despite the risks, despite the mathematical limitations, despite the typical five-day trade for a weekend, despite all of it, you might stand firm and try your luck. While victory isn't impossible, I need mention a few things: Slowlane winners are usually extremely talented, elderly, or overworked.

HOW TO WIN THE SLOWLANE: THE "SECRET EXIT"

The Slowlane can be defied if you find its "secret exit," its "get out of jail free" card that neutralizes the limitations of Uncontrollable Limited Leverage. That secret Slowlane escape?

Fame. Fame breaks the mathematical limitations of intrinsic value. Those who defy the Slowlane are the most pervasive in our culture because of fame—the pro